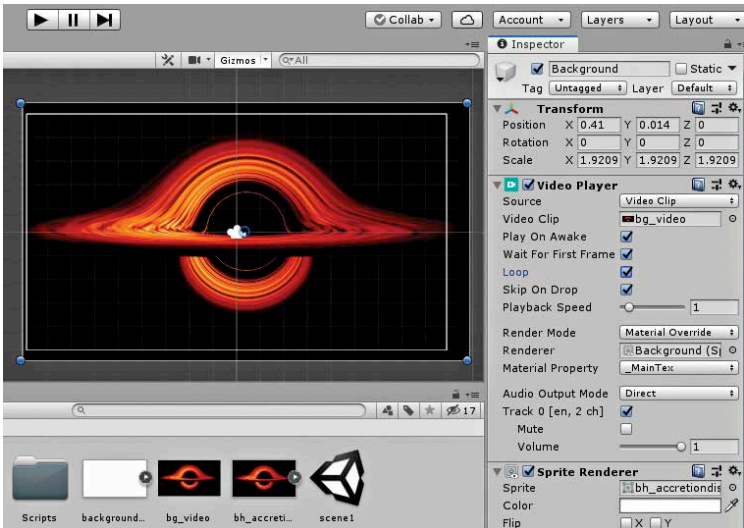


First, let us start with the background. We will be using the visualisation of an black hole by NASA. The main considerations are picking a large enough, widescreen image. We got a .gif animation for the background to keep it dynamic and interesting. It also serves as a distraction that prevents the player from focusing on the enemy ships. Now, Unity did not support .gif animations natively for the longest time. If you do import one now, it works, but without controls for looping, and speed of playback, factors that are important in creating a game. There are however, many workarounds, including using scripts and sprite animations. What we will be doing is simply converting the .gif file to a video. You can use Adobe Photoshop, or a free software known as Avidemux to do the same. What you need is an .mp4 file. Now, import the .mp4 file into the project, let us call it `bg_video`. We also need a blank image of the same dimension as a single frame of the video. This can be a simple white image, or an image of any colour really, it does not matter. We will be doing something smart and using a single frame of the same .gif. The video does not playback in the scene view and the game view, but using a single frame allows us to get an idea of how the game will look, instead of working with a blank background during the game design process. Import this single frame or blank image into the project as well, and drag it into the Hierarchy panel. Name it something like `background_video`



The required settings for the Video Player component